

Diversity in a Globalized World

Semana Tec, Gpo 105

TECNOLÓGICO DE MONTERREY

bgpopescu.net/teaching/diversity

Course Information

Course Title: Diversity in a Globalized World

Group: Gpo 105

Duration: 5 sessions (Semana Tec)

Schedule: Monday to Friday, 13:10 – 15:50

Location: Aulas 11201

Instructor

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Office Hours: By appointment

Course Description

Globalization made the world richer on average. Averages hide the interesting part. The same process that raised a country's income closed particular factories, pushed particular people across borders, and left particular groups living apart. This week we go looking for those people and places in the data: **who paid** for competition from China, and where AI is landing now; what those losses did to **politics**; why people **leave home**, and what they send back; and finally, in Mexico, **who lives next to whom**.

Underneath runs a second course, about evidence. The same moves come up every day: a map that shows what an average hides, two economists reading one event in opposite ways, a pattern that three different stories would explain equally well. By Friday your team will have built an argument like this yourselves. No economics, statistics or programming is required. Make your maps and graphs in Excel, Tableau or — ideally — R, and use AI tools such as ChatGPT if they help, as long as you say so.

Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. **Describe** the uneven geography of globalization — where trade shocks, migration, remittances, and AI exposure actually land — and explain why a national average often describes nobody.

2. **Explain** the main mechanisms connecting economic change to political backlash, and distinguish economic from cultural accounts of populism.
3. **Explain** why people migrate, why development can *raise* emigration before lowering it, and what the evidence says about migration and wages.
4. **Measure** how unevenly two groups are distributed across a city, and say why the answer depends on the unit of analysis chosen.
5. **Read a claim critically** — state what a figure asks you to believe, name what else could have produced it, and say what the data cannot show.
6. **Produce a short empirical report** containing maps and graphs made with Excel, Tableau or R, with an interpretation written in their own words and an honest declaration of how AI was used.

The Sessions

Day	Session	Question
Monday	The China Shock and AI Populism and Democratic Erosion Migration — <i>optional</i>	Who paid for globalization?
Tuesday		What did those losses do to politics?
Wednesday		Why do people leave, and what follows them back?
Thursday	Segregation	Do different people ever actually meet?
Friday	Final Presentations	What did your team find?

Wednesday 16 September is Independence Day, so that session is optional.

Assessment

The final grade has four components:

- **Team report** — 40%
- **Final presentation** — 25%
- **Reading quiz** — 25%
- **Contributions to class** — 10%

Team report. In teams of three, you produce one report containing two to three maps, one simple graph, one more complex graph, an interpretation in your own words, and a table declaring your use of AI. Make the figures with any tool: Excel, Tableau or, ideally, R. Worked examples and the datasets are linked from the session pages. Due **Friday at 13:10**, the start of the final session: submit the report as a PDF, plus the file you made the figures in. Each student's mark is the team's mark, adjusted by team member evaluation.

How the report is marked. Out of the 40 points:

	Points	Full marks means
The question	6	One specific question, answerable with the data you have

	Points	Full marks means
The figures	10	Two to three maps, one simple graph, one more complex graph — titled, labelled, sourced, readable
The interpretation	12	You say what each figure shows, in your own words, and what it means
What you cannot say	8	Who is counted, which unit, and one rival explanation you cannot rule out
AI and working file	4	The declaration table is complete, and your file opens and produces the figures

The two largest rows are interpretation and limits. Good figures with nothing said about them do not pass.

Final presentation. Each team presents its report on Friday. Ten minutes, plus questions. Show your maps and say what they mean; do not read from the slide. Out of the 25 points:

	Points	Full marks means
The question	4	Stated in one sentence, at the start
The figures, explained	7	You show a figure and talk the room through it
What you cannot say	5	You name the limitation that most threatens your own conclusion
Answering questions	7	Whoever made a choice can explain it — including where AI helped
Time and teamwork	2	Ten minutes, and everyone speaks

Reading quiz. Twenty multiple-choice questions on the four required articles, five per article. Twenty minutes, on paper, closed book, at the start of Friday's session.

Contributions to class. The average of attendance, participation in the in-class exercises, and progress on the report.

Worked Example Reports

Three finished reports built from this course's data. They are the model for your own — open one before you write anything, and copy its structure. They were made in R, but the same structure works in any tool.

- **The China Shock** — three maps, a simple graph, a complex graph. The cleanest template.
- **Whose jobs?** — the same data asking a question the original authors did not.
- **Ask or delegate?** — global AI use, and an honest section on who the data actually describes.

What has to be yours is the **question**, the **choice of variables**, and the **interpretation**. The structure you may take.

Reading

Each session has **one required article**, listed on that session's page. We read it together in the second half of the session, and you finish it at home if you need to. Given that this is a one-week intensive course the list is deliberately short. Every article is in the folder in **English and in Spanish** — read whichever you prefer. The required articles are in the shared [readings folder](#).

A twenty-question quiz at the start of Friday's session covers all four articles, and it is worth a quarter of your grade.

Software

Use any tool you are comfortable with: **Excel**, **Tableau** or **R**. R is recommended, and it is what the worked examples use. If you choose R, you will need **R**, **RStudio** and **Quarto** installed, or a free [Posit Cloud](#) account if the installation gives you trouble — it runs RStudio in your browser with nothing to install.

For R, each session page lists optional slide decks from the [research workshop](#). Between them they cover everything the report needs and nothing more: loading a data file, making a graph, making a map, and splitting a graph into panels. The workshop's statistics and regression decks are **not** part of this course.

Use of AI

You may use AI tools such as ChatGPT in this course, and you must declare it. Every report ends with a short table naming what you used it for, what you asked, and how you checked the answer.

Two rules apply throughout. **Never submit code, figures or prose you cannot explain** — you will be asked. And use AI for the mechanical parts, not the judgement: fixing an error message is a good use, deciding what your research question is or what your map means is not.

1 Who Paid for Globalization? The China Shock and AI

Lecture

[Open the Slides](#)

How to read an academic article

A short deck on reading papers without reading every word: the multi-pass strategy, how to read a figure, and how to use AI on a paper without letting it read for you.

[Open the Slides](#)

Data

- [China Shock data](#)
- [AI data](#)

Reading

We read this article together in the second half of the session, in pairs, section by section: [guided reading slides](#).

Autor, D. H., Dorn, D., & Hanson, G. H. (2016). “The China Shock: Learning from Labor-Market Adjustment to Large Changes in Trade.” *Annual Review of Economics*, 8, 205–240. ([PDF](#)) û ([PDF en español](#))

Optional: R and Quarto

Only if you want to make your figures in R.

- [Lecture 2 — Essential Tools for Writing a Paper](#) — install R, RStudio and Quarto, then render your first HTML document
- [Lecture 3 — Operations and Objects in R](#) — objects, vectors, classes — skip the installation slides, you did those

2 Populism and Democratic Erosion

Lecture

[Open the Slides](#)

Data

- [Democracy data](#)

Reading

We read this article together in the second half of the session.

Bermeo, N. (2016). “On Democratic Backsliding.” *Journal of Democracy*, 27(1), 5–19. ([PDF](#)) û ([PDF en español](#))

Optional: R and Quarto

Only if you want to make your figures in R.

- [Lecture 6 — Working with Data in R](#) — data frames, loading an .rds file, relative paths, installing packages
- [Lecture 7 — Dplyr and Basic Visualization](#) — filtering and selecting, and your first ggplot

3 People on the Move

Wednesday 16 September is Independence Day, so this session is optional.

Lecture

[Open the Slides](#)

Data

- [Migration data](#)

Reading

We read this article together in the second half of the session, in pairs, section by section: [guided reading slides](#).

Clemens, M. A. (2011). “Economics and Emigration: Trillion-Dollar Bills on the Sidewalk?” *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 25(3), 83–106. ([PDF](#)) ù ([PDF en español](#))

The PDF is the working-paper version of the same article (CGD Working Paper 264), so its page numbers differ from the journal’s.

Optional: R and Quarto

Only if you want to make your figures in R.

- [Lecture 13 — Data Visualization in R 1](#) — the grammar of graphics, and `geom_sf()` — this is how you make a map
- [Lecture 14 — Data Visualization in R 2](#) — aesthetics and colour scales

4 Who Lives Next to Whom

Lecture

[Open the Slides](#)

Data

- [Mexican municipio data](#)

Reading

We read this article together in the second half of the session, in pairs, section by section: [guided reading slides](#).

Arceo-Gómez, E. O., & Campos-Vázquez, R. M. (2014). “Race and Marriage in the Labor Market: A Discrimination Correspondence Study in a Developing Country.” *American Economic Review*, 104(5), 376–380. ([PDF](#)) ù ([PDF en español](#))

The PDF is the longer working-paper version (MPRA Paper 48000, 2013). It reports the same experiment in more detail than the five-page journal article.

Optional: R and Quarto

Only if you want to make your figures in R.

- [Lecture 15 — Data Visualization in R 3](#) — facets — how your simple graph becomes the complex one

- [Lecture 8 — Visualizing Data Distributions in R](#) — histograms and bar charts. Optional, if you have the appetite

5 Final Presentations

What happens today

Three things: a short quiz on the week's reading, the close of the course, and your team's presentation.

The quiz

We begin with **twenty multiple-choice questions** on the four required articles, five per article. Twenty minutes, on paper, closed book. It is **25% of your grade**.

Your report is due at 13:10

Submit two files on Canvas:

- the report, as a PDF
- the file you made the figures in: your .qmd (R), .xlsx (Excel) or .twbx (Tableau)

The second file is not optional. It is how I see that the work is yours.

The presentation

Ten minutes per team, plus questions.

Structure it the way your report is structured:

1. **The question** — one sentence. What did you want to know?
2. **The maps** — show them. Say where the dark areas are and what that means.
3. **The graph** — what relationship did you find?
4. **What you cannot say** — the limitation that most threatens your conclusion.
5. **One thing that surprised you.**

Show your figures and talk about them. Do not read from the slide, and do not put code or spreadsheets on screen.

The marks are split five ways — question 4, figures explained 7, what you cannot say 5, answering questions 7, time and teamwork 2. The breakdown is on the [syllabus](#).

Questions you should expect

- What is one row in your data?
- Why did you choose that colour scale? What would a different one have shown?
- Your two variables move together. Name something other than causation that would produce that pattern.
- Which part of your figures did AI help with, and how did you check it?